

The Admin Console

An operations manual for the TIC team — what every screen does, how to work each queue, and what is finished, what is still moving, and what was deliberately left out.

Audience	TIC admin operators
Console	iitgtic.itsjeu.com/tic-admin
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Status	Console complete · email domain cutover pending

00 How to read this book

Part One is orientation — signing in, the shape of the console, and the order to work in on a normal day. Part Two is the reference: one chapter per screen, each with what it is for, what every button does, and the mistakes worth avoiding. Part Three is the ledger of what has been built and tested. Part Four is for whoever keeps the lights on.

The status marks

Every feature in this book carries one of three marks. They mean exactly this and nothing softer:

DONE Built, working on the live site, and exercised end to end.

IN PROGRESS Working, but something outside the code is still missing.

NOT DOING Considered and rejected on purpose, with the reason given.

A “Not doing” is not a gap. It is a decision, and the reason is recorded so nobody re-opens it by accident.

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01 Getting in

There is one sign-in door for the whole site. What you see after it depends on what your account is, not on which address you typed.

1.1 The one door

Everyone — TIC staff, founders, and the people founders add to their startups — signs in at `/login`. The server reads your account's role and opens the matching console: admins land in `/tic-admin`, founders in `/founder`. You never need to remember a second address.

- 1 Go to `iitgtic.itsjeu.com/login`.
- 2 Enter your email and password. Complete the bot check if it appears — it is Cloudflare Turnstile and usually passes without a click.
- 3 You arrive on the Overview screen. The sidebar on the left is the whole console.

1.2 Your session

Signing in issues a signed, `httpOnly` session cookie that lasts **eight hours**. It cannot be read by anything running in the page, and it is tied to you personally — every change you make in the console is recorded against your name, not against “the system”.

Sign out from the menu in the top-right of any console screen. Closing the tab does not sign you out; the eight hours do.

1.3 The very first admin

On a brand-new installation there are no accounts at all, so there is nobody to sign in as.

`/tic-admin/login` exists for exactly that one moment: it offers a setup form, takes the bootstrap password from the server's environment, and creates the first admin. After that it stops granting access forever, and every further admin is created from **Users** → **+ New admin** (\$9).

IF THE SETUP FORM APPEARS AND ADMINS ALREADY EXIST

The environment is wrong, not the database. That screen is chosen by counting admin accounts, so anything that stops the count — a key from the wrong Supabase project, a typo in the project URL, an unreachable host — used to look identical to a fresh install. The console now names the actual failure and refuses to bootstrap while it cannot read the table. Do not try to “set it up again”. Call the maintainers (\$20).

1.4 Who is who

ROLE	WHAT IT IS	CREATED BY
Admin	TIC team. Sees everything, decides everything, every action audited.	Another admin, in Users
Founder	Runs one or more startups. Registers them, applies for incubation, posts roles, adds team members — nothing of which is public until an admin approves it.	Self, at <code>/apply</code>
Team member	Someone a founder added to their startup. Waits in the Approvals queue before it can do anything.	A founder, approved by an admin
Visitor	No account. Reads the public site and can apply to one advertised role without signing up.	—

Founders and their team members sign themselves up. **Only admin accounts are created inside the console.**

02 The console at a glance

Thirteen screens, grouped into four bands in the sidebar. The grouping is the argument: the first band is the work that comes to you, the second is the people doing it, the third is the site itself, the fourth is help.

2.1 The sidebar

SECTION	WHAT IT IS FOR	CHAPTER
Overview	Counts and the queues that need attention right now	\$3
Approvals	Everything founders have sent for a decision — four queues in one screen	\$4
Companies	The register of startups and their verification state	\$5
Applications	Incubation applications, from submitted to accepted	\$6
Posted jobs	Every role on the public board, TIC's own and the startups'	\$7
Role applicants	People who applied to an advertised role	\$8
Users	All accounts — roles, suspension, deletion, new admins	\$9
Activity	The audit trail, and how much traffic each page gets	\$10
Content	The copy and images on every public page	\$11
Email	Usage against the plan, the delivery log, suppressions	\$12–13
Storage	Files in every bucket, with a guarded delete	\$14
Support	Who to call when something is wrong	\$20

The **spark button** in the header, beside your name, opens the assistant (\$15) from any screen.

2.2 Conventions you will meet everywhere

The screen never blanks

Every section is rendered by the server before it is sent, so moving between sections keeps the current screen on show until the next one is ready. If a screen looks stuck, it is loading, not broken.

Toasts confirm, they do not ask

A short message slides in at the corner after every action — green for done, red for refused. If no toast appears, the action did not run.

Anything destructive asks first

Deletes and take-downs open a proper dialog that traps focus and closes on `Esc`. There are no browser `confirm()` pop-ups anywhere in the console. Read the sentence in the dialog — it names exactly what is about to go.

A refusal needs a reason

Anywhere you send something back to a founder, the reason box is not optional. The founder reads that sentence in their own console, and a refusal they cannot read is a dead end for both of you.

Private documents are never public links

Resumes, pitch decks, CVs and financials live in private buckets. The console hands out a link that **expires after ten minutes**. Reload the page for a fresh one; never paste one into an email.

2.3 A suggested daily round

- 1 **Overview.** Read the tiles. Anything with a number on it is work waiting.
- 2 **Approvals.** Clear it. Nothing a founder writes is public until you do, so this queue is the one that holds the site up.
- 3 **Role applicants** → the *new* tab. Shortlist, send on, or decline. Each decision emails the applicant.
- 4 **Applications** → the *New* tab. Open, read, move to under review or decide.
- 5 **Email.** Glance at the usage meter and the failed tab. A run of failures means something is wrong upstream.
- 6 **Activity**, weekly. Skim what changed and who changed it.

03 Overview

The landing screen. It is a set of counts, and the ones that are clickable are the ones that mean somebody is waiting.

TIC Admin · Overview			/tic-admin
TILE	READS	GOES TO	
Pending companies	Startups registered but not yet verified	Companies	
Verified companies	Startups cleared to appear and to post roles	—	
Rejected	Startups refused, with the reason on the record	—	
User-posted jobs	Roles written by startups, as opposed to TIC's own seed posts	Posted jobs	
New applications	Incubation applications nobody has opened yet	Applications	
New role applicants	People who applied to a role and have not been triaged	Role applicants	

READ THE TILES AS A QUEUE, NOT AS A DASHBOARD

These numbers are not performance metrics. Each one is a count of people waiting for a decision from the TIC team. A number that stays high for a week is a founder or an applicant hearing nothing.

DONE Built, live and exercised.

04 Approvals

Nothing a founder writes reaches the public site until it is approved here. Four queues share one screen, and the screen is empty when there is nothing to decide.

4.1 The four queues

QUEUE	WHAT IS WAITING	YOUR TWO BUTTONS
New startups	A founder registered a company. Shows the contact person, email, phone, website and the date it was registered.	Verify · Refuse
Job postings	A role written by a startup. Read expands the sector, the full description and the apply link before you decide.	Approve · Send back
Team members	Somebody a founder added to their startup. Until approved, that person can sign in but can do nothing.	Approve · Send back
Company detail changes	An edit to a verified startup's own details — name, website, contact person, contact email, phone — shown as a before-and-after per field.	Approve · Send back

4.2 Working the queue

- 1 Read the entry. On a job posting, press **Read** first — approving a description you have not read is how a bad role reaches the board.
- 2 To accept, press the primary button. The change is live on the public site immediately and the founder is told.
- 3 To refuse, **type the reason in the box first**, then press the red button. The console will stop you and say so if the box is empty.

THE UNVERIFIED-COMPANY FLAG

A job posting from a startup that is not yet verified carries a line saying so. Approving that role does *not* put it on the board — the startup itself has to be verified first. Deal with the startup in the **New startups** queue, or in Companies (\$5), and the role appears.

WHY A REASON IS COMPULSORY

The founder reads your sentence in their own console, beside the thing that came back. “Send back” with no reason produces a founder who resubmits the same thing. One line — “*the description names a salary we cannot advertise*” — closes the loop.

DONE All four queues live, decisions audited, refusal reasons reaching the founder console.

05 Companies

The register of every startup account. Approvals (\$4) is the inbox; this is the permanent record, and the place to change a decision you have already made.

5.1 The table

Columns: **Company**, **Contact**, **Website**, **Status**, **Signed up**, **Actions**. A refused company keeps the reason on the row so nobody has to go hunting for why.

Statuses

STATUS	MEANS
pending	Registered, waiting on TIC. Invisible on the public site; cannot post roles.
verified	Cleared. Its approved roles appear on the Opportunities board and it can read its own applicants.
rejected	Refused, with the reason recorded and sent to the founder.

5.2 The actions

BUTTON	WHAT HAPPENS
Approve	Moves the startup to <i>verified</i> . Its approved roles go live. A “company verified” email goes out.
Reject	Opens a reason box, then moves it to <i>rejected</i> . A “not verified” email goes out carrying your reason.
Revert	Puts a decided company back to <i>pending</i> . Use this when you decided too early. It sends nothing — returning a record to its opening state is an internal correction, not news for the founder.
Delete	Removes the account for good. Asks first. This is not a way to hide a company from the board — refuse it instead.

DELETE IS NOT THE SAME AS REJECT

Reject keeps the record, the reason, and the audit trail, and the founder is told. **Delete** removes the account. Reach for reject in almost every case; keep delete for duplicates, tests and accounts created in error.

DONE Verify, refuse, revert and delete all live, each one audited and each one emailing the right message.

06 Incubation applications

The eight-step, 38-question application a founder fills in per startup, with four document uploads. This is where it is read and decided.

6.1 The queue

Five tabs, each carrying its own count: **New** · **Under review** · **Accepted** · **Rejected** · **All**. The table shows the startup, the founder, when it was submitted, its status, and — on anything decided — the note that went with the decision.

From the row you can **Review** (open it in full), **Accept**, or **Reject**. Accepting or rejecting from the row is for the obvious cases; anything you have not read should be opened.

6.2 Reading one in full

Review opens the whole application: every answer, grouped as the founder filled it in, and the four documents — pitch deck, founder CV, financials, incorporation certificate.

THE DOCUMENT LINKS EXPIRE

Each document has an **Open** button that signs a fresh link good for ten minutes. If a link has gone stale, reload the page. A document that was never uploaded reads *File missing* rather than a dead button.

6.3 Deciding

The review panel has two text boxes and three buttons.

Message to applicant	Goes into the email the founder receives. Write it as if they will read only this sentence, because they will.
Internal note	Stays in the console. For the team, never sent.
Accept	Moves to <i>accepted</i> and sends the acceptance email.
Mark under review	Signals the team has it in hand. Sends the “under review” email.
Reject	Moves to <i>rejected</i> and sends the decline, carrying your message.
Delete application	Removes the record and its uploaded documents. Asks first.

DELETING TAKES THE DOCUMENTS WITH IT

These are somebody’s financials and identity documents. Deleting the application removes the files from storage first, on purpose — but it is irreversible, and the record of the application goes with it. Reject rather than delete unless the entry is a duplicate or a test.

DONE Queue, full review, signed document links, three-way decision and delete, all audited and each state emailing the founder.

07 Posted jobs

Every role currently on the Opportunities board, from both sources, in one table.

7.1 Two kinds of role

TAB	WHERE IT COMES FROM	CAN YOU TAKE IT DOWN?
TIC jobs	The centre's own openings, seeded in the site's content	Edit them in Content (\$11)
Startup jobs	Written by a verified startup in its own console and approved by TIC	Yes — take down from here

Columns: **Role, Company, Type, Sector, Source, Posted, Approval.**

7.2 Taking a role down

Deleting a company-posted role removes it from the public board. It does not delete the people who already applied to it — their applications keep a snapshot of the role and company name, so the Role applicants screen still reads correctly after the posting is gone.

AN EDIT RE-QUEUES A LIVE ROLE

When a startup edits a role that is already public, it goes back into Approvals (\$4) and comes off the board until it is approved again. That is intended: an approved description is what was approved, not whatever it was later changed into.

DONE

08 Role applicants

People who applied to an advertised role. Applying needs no account, so this is the one queue where the person on the other end has no console to check — every decision here is communicated by email, and only by email.

8.1 The pipeline

STATUS	MEANS	EMAIL SENT
new	Just arrived. Nobody has looked.	“Application received”, on submit
shortlisted	Worth taking further.	“Shortlisted”
forwarded	Sent on to the company that posted the role.	“Sent to the company”
rejected	Not taken forward.	“Not taken forward”

The tabs mirror those states. A per-role dropdown — **Every role** by default — narrows the table to one posting.

8.2 What you can do

Open application	The full record: contact details, every answer, and a signed link to the resume good for ten minutes.
Shortlist	Moves to <i>shortlisted</i> and emails the applicant.
Sent on	Moves to <i>forwarded</i> and emails the applicant. Use it when the company has actually been given the application.
Decline	Moves to <i>rejected</i> and emails the applicant.
Export CSV	Downloads what is currently in view — every role, or the one selected in the dropdown. The file is date-stamped.

EACH BUTTON SENDS A REAL EMAIL TO A REAL PERSON

There is no draft state here. Pressing **Decline** tells somebody they did not get the job. Check you are on the right row — the table is sorted by date, and rows move as you filter.

8.3 Resumes and retention

Resumes sit in a private bucket, one folder per role. Nothing about them is public. Deleting an applicant removes the file first and the row second, so no resume is left orphaned in storage. A console action can also clear a whole role at once, resumes first, for when a posting is finished with.

THERE IS DELIBERATELY NO AUTOMATIC PURGE

A scheduled deletion of people's documents is only ever noticed after it has already run. Clearing is a decision somebody makes, on a role, on purpose.

8.4 What the startup sees

A verified startup reads the applicants for its own roles at `/founder/applicants` — contact details, answers, signed resume links and its own CSV export. It **cannot** see your review notes, and it has no way to change a status. Triage stays with TIC.

DONE Queue, tabs, filter, export, three-way triage, signed resume links, safe deletion, applicant emails at every step.

09 Users

Every account on the system, whatever kind. This is the only screen that can create an admin.

9.1 The tabs

All · Admins · Founders · Never signed in · Suspended. “Never signed in” is the useful one: an account created but never used is usually a typo in an email address.

Columns: Account, Role, Last signed in, Joined, Actions. Two badges may appear beside the role — *suspended* and *unconfirmed* (the person never clicked the link in their confirmation email).

9.2 What you can do

Change role	The dropdown on the row. Promoting somebody to admin gives them everything in this book.
Suspend	Blocks sign-in without deleting anything. Reversible with Restore . This is the right first move for a compromised or disputed account.
Delete	Removes the account. Asks first. Irreversible.
+ New admin	Name, email, and a temporary password you choose. They sign in with it at <code>/login</code> and change it themselves afterwards.

YOU CANNOT ACT ON YOURSELF

Your own row has no buttons and its role dropdown is disabled. It is not possible to suspend, delete or demote yourself out of the console by accident.

HAND THE TEMPORARY PASSWORD OVER OUT OF BAND

It is shown once, in plain text, on the screen that creates the account. Send it by a channel the person already controls — not in the same email as their address, and not in a shared inbox.

DONE Roles, suspend/restore, delete, admin creation, self-protection.

10 Activity

Two things on one screen: what changed in the data, and what people looked at on the site.

10.1 The audit log

One entry per change to a company, a job, an application or a profile, showing **who, what, when**, and — expanded — a **Field / Before / After** table for every value that moved.

THE LOG IS WRITTEN BY THE DATABASE, NOT BY THE CONSOLE

It is written by Postgres triggers, so a row changed through any route — the console, a script, the SQL editor — is recorded the same way. It is not possible to make a change that the console then declines to log. This is why the log is worth trusting in a dispute.

An admin action names the person who took it, not “the system”. The **How this log works** panel on the screen restates this in one paragraph for anyone reading over your shoulder.

10.2 Page impressions

A card per public page over **All, 30 days or 7 days**, with three numbers: total impressions, unique human visitors, and bot hits. Crawlers are separated out by user agent rather than being quietly counted as people, so the human figure is the one to quote.

Recent visits beneath it is the raw tail — the last page views as they arrived.

ADMIN TRAFFIC IS FLAGGED, NOT HIDDEN

Views of console pages are recorded and attributed to the signed-in admin. They are marked as such, so your own clicking around does not inflate a public page's numbers.

DONE Trigger-written audit with before/after diffs; impressions with bot separation over three ranges.

11 Content

Every word and every image on the public site is edited here. No developer, no deploy, no waiting.

11.1 How it works

The site is built from a set of named **sections** — one per page or per block of a page. The index screen lists them; opening one gives you an editor built from the shape of that section's own data. Text fields are inputs, long copy is a textarea, lists can be reordered and added to, and nested groups open into their own sub-forms.

The consequence worth knowing: **a new field becomes editable the moment it exists**. Nobody has to build an admin screen for it.

11.2 Editing a section

- 1 Open the section from the Content index.
- 2 Edit the fields. Nothing is written while you type — the editor works on a copy.
- 3 Press **Save changes**. The button reads *Saved* when there is nothing outstanding, so an unsaved edit is visible at a glance.
- 4 The public site is showing it immediately. Open the page in another tab to check.

Reset to default copy throws your edits away and restores the text the site shipped with. It asks first.

11.3 Images

Any field that is an image — a photo, a logo, an avatar, an icon — renders as a preview with an **Upload image** button and a box to paste a URL into instead. Uploads go to the public site-assets bucket and the URL is saved into the section.

CONSTRAINT	VALUE
Maximum size	5 MB per image
Accepted	Images only — the bucket refuses anything else
Who can upload	Admins only. There is no other write path into that bucket.

People cards — team, governing body, mentors — each carry an avatar. A card shows the photograph when one is set and keeps a plain circle when it is not, so the pages read correctly before the photography arrives.

11.4 Two things editing content also changes

- **Search snippets.** A page's meta description is read from its own opening copy, so rewriting the introduction rewrites what Google shows.
- **The audit trail.** Every save records a before and an after in Activity (\$10), so a change can be read back — and undone by hand — later.

THE SITE CANNOT BE TAKEN DOWN BY A BAD SAVE

A section that has never been saved, or a database that cannot be reached, falls back to the copy bundled with the site. The worst a bad edit does is show the wrong words on one section until it is fixed or reset.

DONE Schema-driven editor, image upload per field, audited saves, per-section reset. **IN PROGRESS** The real photography, logos and startup marks — placeholders in several places today.

12 Email

Everything the system has ever tried to send, whether it arrived, how much of the monthly allowance is left, and who can no longer be written to.

12.1 The meters

Across the top: the **plan** in use, this month's and today's sends against their caps, **delivered all time**, and a **last 30 days** trend. The allowance is counted from the log itself, and the same check runs before every send — a message that would exceed the cap is recorded as *blocked* rather than being thrown at the provider to fail.

12.2 The delivery log

One row per attempt, with the recipient, template, subject and time. Tabs: **All** · **Sent** · **Failed** · **Blocked**, and a switch to **include test sends**, which are hidden by default.

STATUS	MEANS	WHAT TO DO
sent	Accepted by the provider, with a message id.	Nothing. Delivery feedback arrives separately.
failed	Rejected, or the request never completed.	One is noise. A run of them is a real fault — call \$20.
blocked	Never attempted: no API key, the template is switched off, the allowance is spent, or the address is suppressed.	Read which. The reason is the fix.

Opening a row shows **the exact message that person received** — rendered subject and body, not a template. This is the answer to “what did we actually send them?”.

12.3 Suppressed addresses

When a message hard-bounces or somebody marks one as spam, the provider tells the system and the address is taken out of circulation. Nothing is sent to it again until the suppression is lifted, which you can do from this panel. Temporary failures — a full mailbox, a server having a bad afternoon — do not suppress.

LIFT A SUPPRESSION ONLY WHEN YOU KNOW WHY IT HAPPENED

A complaint suppression means a real person marked TIC mail as spam. Sending to them again is how a sending domain's reputation is lost — which costs everybody's delivery, not just theirs.

12.4 Newsletter list

The footer sign-ups, with export, and removal on request. A repeat sign-up is answered as an ordinary success, so the form cannot be used to find out who is already on the list.

THE SANDBOX-SENDER BANNER

If the console shows a banner about sending from a sandbox address, mail is only reaching one inbox — the one that owns the provider account — and every other recipient is getting nothing. That is a configuration problem, not an operator one. Report it.

DONE Meter, log with previews, bounce and complaint feedback, suppressions, newsletter.

IN PROGRESS The production sending domain — see §18.

13 Email templates

The wording of every automatic message, editable without touching a line of HTML.

13.1 Blocks, not markup

Nobody should have to edit inline-styled table markup to change a sentence, so a message is composed from **blocks**. Each bundled template arrives as a block list you can reorder, duplicate, delete, or clear out and rebuild. A + between any two blocks opens the palette.

GROUP	BLOCKS
Text	Heading · Subheading · Paragraph · Bullet list · Numbered list · Quote · Small print · Signature
Emphasis	Highlight (neutral / positive / negative) · Button · Link
Media	Image · File
Spacing	Divider · Spacer

Inside a text field the only markup is `*bold*` and `[label](https://...)`. Everything else is written exactly as it will be read.

13.2 Only show

Every block carries one visibility rule — *always*, *when the reason is filled in*, or *when the reason is empty*. That is what makes an optional rejection reason disappear cleanly instead of leaving an empty panel in somebody's inbox.

13.3 Variables

A template can drop in values from the record it is about — a name, a role, a reason. The editor lists the ones available to that template; the block editor writes the conditional logic for you.

13.4 The controls

Subject line	Edited above the body. It takes variables too.
Preview	The message as it will arrive, rendered into the shared layout.
Send a test	Sends the current draft to an address you type. Test sends are marked in the log and hidden from it by default.
On / off	Switching a template off stops that message being sent, while still recording each attempt as <i>blocked</i> . Useful while a message is being rewritten.
Reset	Discards your version and puts the bundled copy back.
Images and files	Upload into a public bucket, because an email client fetches an image with no session. A file block can also tick attach it to the email as well , which sends it as a real attachment

alongside the download link.

ONE LAYOUT, ONE PLACE

Every message renders inside a shared layout template — the branding, the header, the footer. Change the layout once and every message changes with it. It is the one template still written as HTML, because it is scaffolding rather than copy.

THE HTML TAB IS A ONE-WAY DOOR

Saving from the HTML tab stores raw markup and the template stays hand-edited — the block editor no longer applies to it — until it is **Reset**. Use blocks unless you have a reason not to.

DONE Block editor, visibility rules, variables, preview, test send, on/off, reset, image and file blocks with attachments.

14 Storage

Every file the system holds, how much room is left, and which files are safe to remove.

14.1 The four buckets

BUCKET	PUBLIC	HOLDS
application-documents	No	Pitch decks, founder CVs, financials, incorporation certificates
job-applications	No	Resumes attached to a role application
site-assets	Yes	Images uploaded for public pages from the content editor
email-assets	Yes	Pictures and documents used inside an email

The two public buckets are a deliberate exception: a page’s `<img>` and an email client both fetch without any session, so anything shown that way has to be reachable without credentials. Only admins can put files into them.

14.2 The screen

Total used, files stored, and remaining across the top; a bar per bucket marked *Public* or *Private* with its file count and size; then the object list, filterable by bucket.

Each object is marked **in use** or **unused**. “In use” means its path was found in a content section, an email template, an application record or a resume record — so a real person’s document is never mislabelled as safe to delete.

14.3 Open and delete

Open	Signs a ten-minute link and opens the file in a new tab. Works for private buckets too.
Delete	Asks once. If the file is still referenced, the delete is refused and a second, blunter dialog appears saying what it would break. Delete anyway overrides it.

“DELETE ANYWAY” MEANS WHAT IT SAYS

The first refusal exists because something on the live site points at that file. Overriding it leaves a broken image on a public page or inside an already-delivered email. Only override when you have already removed the reference, or when you know what will break and accept it.

WHY THIS SCREEN EXISTS

Files live outside the database. A database backup does not contain them, and a database record does not know whether its file is still there. This screen is the only place that reconciles the two.

DONE Usage per bucket, in-use detection across four sources, signed opens, guarded delete with an explicit override.

15 The assistant

A chat window over the console’s own data. It answers from the database, not from anything it was told in advance — and it can edit the website’s copy, with your approval.

15.1 What it can reach

Console-wide counts, companies, incubation applications (including one in full), posted jobs, role applicants, users, the audit trail, site traffic, the email templates and delivery log, newsletter sign-ups, and the live copy of any section of the public site.

Useful questions: *“How many startups are waiting on verification and how long has each been waiting?”* · *“Which role has the most applicants this month?”* · *“Show me what changed on the mentors page last week and who changed it.”*

15.2 What it can change — and what it cannot

IT CAN	IT CANNOT
Edit or reset a section of the website’s copy; edit or reset an email template; send a newsletter or an email to chosen recipients.	Verify a company, move an application, decide an applicant, create or delete a user, delete anything at all. Those stay where they are, on their own screens, where they are attributed and audited.

The list of things it is allowed to do is the security boundary, and it is fixed in the code. No instruction typed into the chat widens it.

15.3 Approving an edit

A toggle in the header sets the mode.

Review	The default. The assistant does not make the change. It shows a before-and-after card with Approve and Reject . Approving runs exactly the same operation it would have run itself, so the audit entry is identical either way.
Auto	Content and template edits happen without asking. Off by default, because these edits reach the live public site.

AUTO NEVER COVERS A SEND
Sending a newsletter or an email is always gated behind an explicit approval, in both modes. There is no setting that lets the assistant mail people on its own.

15.4 Practicalities

Model	Two, chosen in the settings dialog. The default reasons before it answers — the working-out streams into a collapsed block above the reply. The second can <i>look</i> at an attached image.
Attachments	Attach an image and it uploads into the site-assets bucket, so you can say “put this photo on the governing body page” and approve the edit. Attach a PDF and it can ride an email. 5 MB per upload.
The key	Unless the team has a shared one configured, each admin pastes their own API key into the settings dialog. It is held in that browser only, never written to the database and never logged. Rotate it rather than treating it as permanent.
Chat history	Conversations are saved per admin. The history panel reopens or deletes your own; New chat starts a fresh one. Nobody else reads your chats.

CHECK WHAT IT TELLS YOU BEFORE ACTING ON IT

The reply is written from what the tools returned, and it is rendered as untrusted text on purpose. It is very good for “find me the thing” and “summarise the week”. For a decision that sends an email or changes a status, go to the screen and look.

DONE Read tools, content and template writes behind approval, gated sends, image attachments, saved conversations.

16 Mail the system sends

Every automatic message and what triggers it. Nothing here is sent by hand; every one is the consequence of an action on one of the screens above.

MESSAGE	SENT WHEN
Company signup received	A founder creates an account
Company verified	An admin verifies a startup (§5)
Company not verified	An admin refuses a startup, carrying the reason
Application under review	An admin marks an incubation application under review (§6)
Application accepted	An admin accepts it
Application declined	An admin rejects it, carrying the message to the applicant
Role application received	Somebody submits the apply form on a role
Applicant shortlisted	An admin shortlists them (§8)
Application sent to the company	An admin marks it sent on
Not taken forward	An admin declines them

MOVING A RECORD BACKWARDS SENDS NOTHING

Putting a company back to *pending*, an application back to *submitted*, or an applicant back to *new* is an internal correction — not news for the recipient. No mail goes out. This is what makes it safe to fix a mis-click.

MAIL NEVER FAILS YOUR ACTION

If the mail system is down, verifying a company or accepting an application still completes. What went wrong is recorded in the delivery log (§12). You will never be blocked from doing the work because an email could not go out.

Sign-in and password mail is separate

Confirmation emails and password-reset links are sent by the authentication provider, not through the templates above. They will not appear in the delivery log, and their wording is not editable from the console. A reset link lands on a real page that sets a new password; a link that is expired, already used, or opened in a different browser says exactly which.

17 What an admin can and cannot do

Worth reading once, so that you know which of your worries the system already handles and which it does not.

17.1 Who can see what

ACTOR	READS	WRITES
Visitor	Public pages; roles from verified startups	One role application, bot-checked and rate-limited
Founder	Their own startups, applications and applicants	Their own records — none of it public until approved
Team member	Nothing, until an admin approves them	Nothing, until an admin approves them
Admin	Everything	Everything, and every change is audited

These limits are enforced by the database itself, not by hiding buttons. A founder cannot read another startup's applicants by guessing a web address.

17.2 Things the system guarantees

- Every table refuses access by default; each one has explicit rules about who may read and write it.
- The key that bypasses those rules exists only on the server. It is structurally impossible for it to reach a browser — the build fails if it is ever pulled into one.
- Every admin write carries your identity, so the audit log names a person.
- Private documents are only ever reachable through ten-minute signed links.
- Public forms are bot-checked *on the server*, so posting straight to the endpoint does not skip the check, and rate-limited per address.
- A second application from the same email to the same role is refused rather than duplicated.
- Delivery feedback from the mail provider is signature-verified before it is read, and a captured request cannot be replayed.

17.3 Things it does not do for you

- **It cannot undo a send.** Once an email is out, it is out.
- **It cannot recover a deleted account, application or file.** The dialogs ask because the answer is final.
- **It does not review what you publish.** Approving a job description puts that description, as written, on a public page.

- **It does not stop an admin being reckless.** Every admin has every power. Be careful who you promote in §9.

PERSONAL DATA IS REAL DATA

Resumes, CVs, financials and identity documents pass through this console. Do not download them to a shared machine, do not forward a signed link, and do not export a CSV to a personal drive. The export exists for handing a shortlist to the team that needs it, and for nothing else.

18 Feature ledger

What has been built and exercised, what is still moving, and what was decided against. The live version of this list is on the site itself at

`/status` .

18.1 Tested and complete

FEATURE	WHAT “DONE” MEANS HERE
Sign-in and sessions	One door for every role; bot-checked; signed eight-hour cookie; first-admin bootstrap that refuses to run when it cannot read the account table.
Approvals — four queues	Startups, job postings, team members and detail changes, each decided with a reason that reaches the founder’s console.
Companies	Verify, refuse with a reason, revert, delete — each audited, each sending the right message and nothing on a revert.
Incubation applications	Eight-step form of 38 questions with four uploads; queue, full review, ten-minute signed document links, three-way decision, delete that takes the files first.
Role applications	Public apply form needing no account; server-side bot check; role resolved server-side; duplicate application refused; resume in a private bucket.
Role applicant console	Status tabs, per-role filter, CSV export, signed resume links, whole-role clear with the files removed first.
Founder applicant inbox	A verified startup reads its own applicants; TIC’s notes withheld; no write path, so triage stays TIC’s.
Users	Roles, suspend/restore, delete, admin creation, and a self-row that cannot be acted on.
Audit trail	Written by database triggers, so a change made outside the console is logged identically. Before/after per field, attributed to a person.
Traffic	One record per page view, crawlers separated by user agent, console views flagged and attributed.
Content editing	Every public page editable from the console, schema-driven so new fields appear by themselves, audited, per-section reset, falls back to bundled copy if the database is unreachable.
Editable media	Upload an image for any image field; 5 MB cap; image-only; admin-only write path; uploaded and bundled images coexist so content migrates gradually.
Storage console	Walks every bucket through the storage API, marks each file in use or unused against four sources, refuses a delete that would break something, override behind a second dialog.
Transactional email — console	Usage meter, 30-day trend, delivery log with the exact rendered message, test sends hidden by default.
Email templates	Block editor with visibility rules, variables, preview, test send, on/off, reset; images and files including real attachments.
Delivery feedback	Verified end to end: a forged, stale or tampered payload is rejected; a valid bounce or complaint suppresses the address; a replay is deduplicated; a suppressed address is refused before the next send.
Rate limiting	Verified live: the sixteenth write in an hour from one address is refused, on the role application, the signup receipt, the bot check and the admin sign-in.
Newsletter	Footer sign-up that stores what it collects; a repeat address answers as a plain success so the list cannot be probed; signed one-click unsubscribe.

FEATURE	WHAT “DONE” MEANS HERE
Admin assistant	Reads everything an admin can see; writes only site copy and email templates; every write previewed as a before/after and approved; sends always gated; conversations saved per admin.
Search and social	Per-page description, canonical and social card, read from each page’s own copy; consoles and auth pages kept out of search.
Application drafts	The eight-step form autosaves per account, so a refresh does not lose progress. Uploads and consent boxes deliberately excluded.

18.2 In progress

ITEM	WHERE IT STANDS	WHAT IS BLOCKING IT
Production sending domain	Mail works and reaches real recipients today, from a verified development domain. The webhook, the suppressions and the meter are all live and tested.	Not code. DNS access to the official domain, so the provider's records can be published against it.
Restore drill	The backup is complete — schema, data, every table, and every stored file, which a database backup alone never covers. The rehearsal passes: the backup verifies against its own manifest and the target is confirmed reachable.	A throwaway project to restore into for real, once.
Real photography and logos	Every surface that takes a photograph or a logo is built and editable. Several still show placeholders.	The assets themselves.

18.3 Decided against, on purpose

ITEM	WHY NOT
Pre-building public pages at deploy time	It would freeze each page's text at build time, so the content editor would silently stop working on it — and those pages would be served without recording a visit, so the traffic figures would go dark exactly where traffic matters.
Scheduled deletion of resumes	Deleting people's documents on a timer is only ever noticed once it has already run. Clearing a role is a decision somebody makes, deliberately.
Letting the assistant decide records	Verifying a company, moving an application and deciding an applicant stay on their own screens, where a person is named in the audit trail.

ONE KNOWN ASYMMETRY

The founder applicant inbox is pull-only: a startup is not yet notified when a new applicant arrives for one of its roles. Until that changes, telling the company is what **Sent on** in §8 is for.

19 When something goes wrong

Symptoms an operator actually meets, what each usually means, and whether it is yours to fix.

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT IT USUALLY IS	YOURS?
Sign-in bounces you back	Your session ran out its eight hours, or the account was suspended. Try once more; if it still refuses, ask another admin to check your row in Users.	Yes
A first-admin setup form appears	The server cannot read the account table. Environment, not data. Do not complete it.	No — call \$20
“Write a reason first”	You pressed a refuse button with an empty reason box. Type one sentence and press again.	Yes
An approved role is not on the board	The startup that posted it is not verified yet. Verify it in \$5 and the role appears.	Yes
A document link does nothing	It expired — they last ten minutes. Reload the page for a fresh one.	Yes
A whole column of <i>blocked</i> in the mail log	Read the reason: the template is switched off, the monthly allowance is spent, or the address is suppressed. All three are visible on the Email screen.	Yes
A run of <i>failed</i> in the mail log	Something upstream is wrong. Your work still completes — mail never blocks an action — but nobody is being told anything.	No — call \$20
A banner about a sandbox sender	Mail is only reaching one inbox. Everything else is going nowhere.	No — call \$20
A content save does not show on the site	Check the button read <i>Saved</i> , then hard-reload the public page. If it still shows the old words, it may be a section you have not actually edited — sections are per block, not per page.	Yes
A delete is refused with “still in use”	Working as designed. Something on the site points at that file (\$14).	Yes
The assistant will not answer	Usually a missing or expired API key in its settings dialog, or the second model’s key not being allow-listed yet.	Yes
A broken image on a public page	Somebody overrode an in-use delete in Storage. Re-upload the image from Content (\$11).	Yes
A change you cannot explain in Activity	Read the before/after and the name on it. The log records changes made outside the console too, so it is worth trusting.	Ask \$20

WHEN YOU REPORT SOMETHING

Say **which screen you were on**, **what you pressed**, and **what you expected to happen**. A screenshot of the toast message is worth more than a paragraph of description.

20 For the technical caretaker

Not needed to operate the console. Needed by whoever keeps it running.

20.1 Commands

COMMAND	WHAT IT DOES
<code>pnpm doctor</code>	Checks every required setting, catches a key pasted into the wrong slot, connects to the project, and reports how many admins and content sections it can see. The first thing to run when anything looks wrong.
<code>pnpm backup</code>	Schema, data, every table as NDJSON, <i>and every stored file</i> — the half a database backup never covers.
<code>pnpm restore <dir> --dry-run</code>	The drill. Verifies the backup against its manifest, confirms the target is reachable, reports exactly what would be written where, and writes nothing.
<code>pnpm check · pnpm lint</code>	Type-check and lint before a deploy.

WHAT A RESTORE CANNOT PUT BACK FROM JSON

Profiles, companies, jobs and applications are keyed to authentication accounts, and an account cannot be recreated with a chosen identifier. Those tables restore only through the SQL dump. The restore script refuses to write them from JSON rather than silently orphaning records — and says so when it does. Backups contain real personal data; they are kept out of version control.

20.2 Deploys

Hosted on Vercel. A push to the main branch deploys automatically. After a deploy that changes public copy, re-scrape the social preview caches and, if routes changed, resubmit the sitemap.

20.3 Secrets, in one sentence each

- The key that bypasses the database rules lives only on the server, and the build fails if it is ever pulled into a browser bundle.
- Rotating the session secret signs every admin out immediately — which is the fast answer to a compromised session.
- The bootstrap password stops working the moment the first admin exists.
- The assistant's API key is per-browser unless a shared one is configured; rotate rather than treating one as long-lived.

20.4 Who to call

The **Support** screen in the console carries the same two names, so nobody has to find this document in a hurry.

NAME	COVERS	REACH
Jeu Machahary	Site & admin console	hello@itsjeu.com · +91 7896175454
Veeshal D Bodosa	Site & admin console	work@veeshal.me · +91 6000013904

BEFORE HANDOVER

System alerts — “an admin signed in”, “a new applicant signed up” — should go to a real TIC team inbox, not to a developer’s address. That is one setting, and it is worth changing on the day the console becomes the team’s rather than the builder’s.